



Social Science Part 1 — Cbse Half-Yearly Exam — 80 Marks

Subject: Social Science Part 1 | Class: Class 9

Total Marks: 80 | Time Allowed: 3h | CBSE

General Instructions:

1. Read all questions carefully before answering.
2. All questions are compulsory unless stated otherwise.
3. Marks for each question are indicated on the right.
4. Write neatly and legibly.

Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
Section A Attempt all 20 questions. Each carries 1 mark(s).		
1	Autonomous District Councils (ADCs) are established in which specific regions of India? (A) Southern regions (B) North-eastern regions (C) Central regions (D) Western regions <i>[Ch 6: Democracy]</i>	1
2	What were the earliest sources of information about early China called? (A) Papyrus scrolls stored in labeled jars (B) Oracles made on animal bones and tortoise shells (C) Inscriptions on bronze ritual vessels (D) Clay tablets with cuneiform writing <i>[Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]</i>	1
3	During the Mesolithic period, what was the mainstay of the subsistence economy? (A) Cultivation of wheat and barley (B) Fishing, enabled by a variety of microlithic tools to gather aquatic food (C) Hunting large game animals with handaxes and cleavers (D) Domestication of sheep, goats, and cattle <i>[Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]</i>	1



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4	The colourful display of light seen in the sky near the poles is known as Aurora Borealis in the Northern Hemisphere. What is it called in the Southern Hemisphere? (A) Aurora Australis (B) Aurora Solaris (C) Aurora Borealis Australis (D) Aurora Polaris <i>[Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]</i>	1
5	What is the minimum age at which every citizen has the right to vote through a secret ballot in India? (A) 16 years of age and above (B) 18 years of age and above (C) 21 years of age and above (D) 25 years of age and above <i>[Ch 6: Democracy]</i>	1
6	Which of the following best explains why Social Science is relevant to everyday life? (A) It only helps us memorise dates and locations of historical events (B) It focuses exclusively on the study of natural phenomena like physics and chemistry (C) It helps us understand how daily activities rely on systems of governance, economic production, social cooperation, and the natural environment (D) It replaces the need for all other academic disciplines <i>[Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]</i>	1
7	Geography helps answer questions like why India has historically been a hub of global interaction. What geographical feature is cited as facilitating contact with Africa, Europe, and Southeast Asia? (A) The Himalayan mountain range (B) The Thar Desert (C) The Indo-Gangetic plain (D) The Indian peninsula's long coastline <i>[Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]</i>	1
8	Approximately how many registered political parties does India have? (A) Over 2,800 (B) Over 1,500 (C) Over 3,500 (D) Over 5,000 <i>[Ch 6: Democracy]</i>	1



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9	What was the Kudavolai system used for in the Chola period? (A) A ballot pot system for village elections (B) A method of tax collection (C) A system of land distribution (D) A judicial procedure for settling disputes <i>[Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]</i>	1
10	What marked the beginning of what is called 'human behaviour', as opposed to the behaviour of animals? (A) The making of the earliest stone tools around 3.3 million years ago (B) The domestication of animals during the Neolithic period (C) The invention of the bow and arrow by Homo sapiens (D) The development of pictographic script by the Harappans <i>[Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]</i>	1
11	Which of the following is NOT one of the four core disciplines that Social Science primarily draws from in Grades 9–10? (A) Anthropology (B) Geography (C) Political Science (D) Economics <i>[Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]</i>	1
12	The Zabo system in Nagaland is an integrated farming approach that uses which of the following for soil and water conservation? (A) Earthen bunds on hillslopes (B) Terracing on flat plains (C) Concrete dams across rivers (D) Underground pipelines for irrigation <i>[Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]</i>	1
13	Which layer of the atmosphere contains the ozone gas that filters the Sun's harmful ultraviolet radiation? (A) Stratosphere (B) Mesosphere (C) Thermosphere (D) Exosphere <i>[Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]</i>	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
14	Winds are named after the direction they blow from. What is a wind blowing from the west called? (A) Easterly (B) Westerly (C) Northerly (D) Southerly <i>[Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]</i>	1
15	What is the state of the asthenosphere that allows tectonic plates to move? (A) Completely solid (B) Completely liquid (C) Semi-molten (D) Gaseous <i>[Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]</i>	1
16	Which two stages among the four āśhramas of life clearly have a renunciatory connotation? (A) Brahmacharya and Gṛhastha (B) Gṛhastha and Vānaprastha (C) Brahmacharya and Saṃnyāsa (D) Vānaprastha and Saṃnyāsa <i>[Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]</i>	1
17	Which of the following tools is used by Geography to understand concepts and investigate questions? (A) Carbon-14 dating (B) Genealogical records (C) Numismatics (D) Geographical Information System (GIS) <i>[Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]</i>	1
18	By the end of 1400 BCE, the Babylonians lost their prominence. Which combination of factors contributed to this decline? (A) Flooding of the Tigris River and a pandemic disease (B) Repeated attacks by the Hittites, environmental degradation, pressure on agricultural lands, and internal political and economic problems (C) Invasion by the Sumerians and a collapse of the cuneiform script (D) A long drought and the abandonment of cuneiform writing <i>[Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]</i>	1



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19	Which of the following statements correctly connects the role of landforms with the development of early civilisations and trade? (A) Rivers and fertile plains gave rise to agricultural societies, while deserts encouraged trade routes like the Silk Route (B) Deserts like the Thar encouraged the development of large settlements and discouraged trade (C) Coasts and harbours limited cultural contacts with distant lands (D) Mountains prevented all forms of trade and cultural exchange between regions <i>[Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]</i>	1
20	What is the primary mechanism by which Glacial Lake Outburst Floods (GLOFs) occur? (A) Sudden release of large volumes of water from glacial lakes due to natural and climatic factors (B) Overflow of rivers due to heavy monsoon rainfall (C) Melting of permafrost in tundra regions (D) Tsunami waves triggered by undersea earthquakes <i>[Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]</i>	1
Section B Attempt 5 out of 7.		
21	What is sustainable growth as described in the context of economic development? <i>[Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]</i>	2
	OR How does the example of a drought demonstrate the need for multiple Social Science disciplines to understand society? <i>[Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]</i>	
22	What is the objective of the National Monsoon Mission (NMM)? <i>[Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]</i>	2
	OR What were the key inventions of the Sumerians related to their number system, and how do they influence us today? <i>[Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]</i>	
23	What reservation for women does Article 243(d) provide in Panchayats, and how have some states gone further? <i>[Ch 6: Democracy]</i>	2
24	What irrigation structure was built by Karikala Chola, and what does its continued use signify? <i>[Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]</i>	2



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
25	What are Glacial Lake Outburst Floods (GLOFs) and what causes them? <i>[Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]</i>	2
Section C Attempt 5 out of 7.		
26	How does understanding economics contribute to sustainable growth and the wise use of resources? <i>[Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]</i>	3
	OR Discuss the concept of dharma in early Indian thought, including its etymological meaning and its role in society. <i>[Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]</i>	
27	Explain how Economics studies decision-making by consumers, producers, and governments. <i>[Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]</i>	3
	OR Explain the natural causes that led to the severe floods in Punjab in 2025. <i>[Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]</i>	
28	Explain how erosion affects different human occupations and livelihoods, giving specific examples. <i>[Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]</i>	3
29	How does the verse from the Rig Veda reflect the idea of democratic traditions in early Indian thought? <i>[Ch 6: Democracy]</i>	3
30	What was a ziggurat in Sumerian civilisation, and what role did it play in the city's social and economic life? <i>[Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]</i>	3
Section D Attempt 4 out of 6.		
31	Climate change is one of the most urgent challenges facing the Earth today. Discuss the causes and consequences of climate change, and explain how individuals can contribute to reducing its impact through their carbon footprint. <i>[Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]</i>	5
	OR Discuss the various sources used by historians to understand the social realities of the past. How do different historical traditions, including the itihāsa-purāṇa tradition and modern historiography, contribute to the study of history?	



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	<i>[Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]</i>	
32	India is recognised as the world's largest democracy, not merely in terms of numbers but through the sustained involvement of its people. Describe in detail the features that demonstrate the scale, depth, and inclusiveness of Indian democracy. <i>[Ch 6: Democracy]</i>	5
	OR Describe the system of village governance in the Chola empire with special reference to the Uttaramerur inscription and the Kudavolai system. How did the village assemblies function as self-reliant institutions? <i>[Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]</i>	
33	Trace the evolutionary sequence of human ancestors from Homo habilis to Homo sapiens, describing the key technological advancements associated with each stage. How did the development of tools mark the beginning of 'human behaviour'? <i>[Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]</i>	5
34	Explain the structure of the Earth's interior and describe how the movement of tectonic plates shapes the Earth's surface. Include the different types of plate boundaries and their associated landforms in your answer. <i>[Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]</i>	5
Section E Attempt 3 out of 4.		
35	Case Study: Weathering, Erosion, and Human Livelihoods In a region with rocky terrain, plant roots grow into cracks in rocks, gradually splitting them apart. Temperature changes further break the rocks into smaller pieces, but the broken material does not move. Meanwhile, in nearby dry and sandy areas, wind carries away loose soil, and in coastal areas, sea waves wear away the land along the shore. For farmers in this region, the removal of fertile topsoil has led to lower crop yields. Those living near rivers and coasts face land being washed away, damaging houses and roads. Construction and mining activities have become risky as the land has become unstable. Even tourism and fishing suffer as beaches and fertile lands are degraded. (i) Identify the process by which plant roots split rocks apart and name its type. (ii) Distinguish between weathering and erosion based on the movement of material. (iii) Identify the two types of erosion mentioned in the passage and explain how each affects farmers and coastal residents respectively. (iv) Why does erosion pose a safety risk specifically in construction and mining? <i>[Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]</i>	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	OR Case Study: Understanding Society Through a Village's Daily Life A village in India is situated near a long coastline that historically facilitated contact with Africa, Europe, and Southeast Asia. The villagers depend on farming, while some engage in trade. The local Panchayati Raj system gives citizens a voice in local development planning, reflecting grassroots democracy. Roads are maintained by public authorities, and electricity arrives from distant power stations through a vast network. The food villagers eat has been harvested, processed, transported, bought, and sold through the efforts of many people. Social Science helps explain why agriculture flourishes here, how governments make decisions affecting millions, and how environments influence life. Society does not function by chance—it is shaped by history, geography, institutions, resources, and human choices. (i) Define Social Science in simple words. (ii) How does the Panchayati Raj system embody grassroots democracy in India's villages? (iii) Explain how the village's daily life demonstrates the interconnection of multiple Social Science disciplines. Refer to at least two disciplines. (iv) Why does the passage state that 'society does not function by chance'? What factors shape it? <i>[Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]</i>	
36	Case Study: Punjab Floods 2025 In 2025, Punjab experienced severe floods due to heavy monsoon rains and the consecutive swelling of the rivers Satluj, Beas, and Ravi. The floods damaged large parts of the state, including villages, agricultural fields, houses, and infrastructure such as roads and bridges. The disaster was triggered by very heavy monsoon rains intensified by western disturbances that brought more moisture. Additionally, weak and old river embankments known as dhusi bandh, construction of houses and farms near rivers, and silt accumulation in dams worsened the situation. The floods led to loss of lives, displacement to relief camps, damage to paddy crops, and outbreaks of waterborne diseases. (i) Which rivers are mentioned as swelling and causing severe flooding in Punjab? (ii) How did western disturbances contribute to the flooding in Punjab? (iii) Explain two human-made factors that aggravated the floods in Punjab. (iv) What was one major health consequence of the murky standing water left by the floods? <i>[Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]</i>	5



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37	Case Study: Egyptian Civilisation — Calendar, Agriculture and Governance About 5000 years ago, farmers discovered that by digging ditches they could divert water from the Nile into their fields and store water in reservoirs for later use. By counting the days between Nile floods, the Egyptians developed a calendar. The Egyptian calendar has three seasons — Inundation (autumn), Peret growing (winter) and shemu harvest (summer). It is based on the rising of Sirius (Dog Star), with a year of 365 days. The need to dig ditches and construct dams required collective effort, which led to the growth of local government and the rise of an administrative class — probably the earliest form of local government in Egypt. (i) What are the three seasons of the Egyptian calendar? (ii) On what astronomical basis was the Egyptian calendar founded? (iii) How did agricultural needs contribute to the rise of local government in Egypt? (iv) Why was the Egyptian calendar of 365 days not perfectly accurate? <i>[Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]</i>	5

